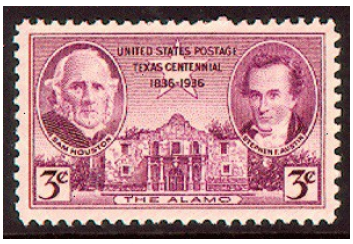
VOL 129 #6 NOVEMBER – DECEMBER 2023

THE OFFICIAL PUBLICATION OF THE SAN ANTONIO PHILATELIC ASSOCIATION FOUNDED 1896

The PHILATEX

AMERICA'S STAMP CLUB
STAMPS.ORG

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388



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T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3

MEETING CALENDAR 2023

NOVEMBER			DECEMBER		
3	BOG & Meeting "Show & Tell"	7:15 pm 7:30 pm	1	BLUE CHIP AUCTION	7:30 pm
10	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:15)	7:30 pm	8	CHRISTMAS PARTY & Election of Officers – In the Fireside Room	6:00 pm
17	Bourse & Bags - buy, sell & trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:30 pm	15	Bourse & Bags – buy, sell & trade, & Bag Night! (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:30 pm
24	No Meeting – THANKSGIVING		22 & 29	No Meeting – CHRISTMAS & NEW YEAR'S DAY	
January 5 - Show &Tell; 12 - Auction; 19 - Program 26 - Bourse					

EDITOR'S CORNER

T. P. A. CHAPTER 3, LIFE CHAPTER 3

San Antonio Philatelic Association

A. P. S. CHAPTER No. 388

— FOUNDED 1896 —

GREETINGS YA'LL. DUES TIME IS SOON APPROACHING. THE AMOUNT FOR RETURNING MEMBERS IS $20.00. THE AMOUNT FOR A NEW MEMBERSHIP IS $25.00. THE PRICE FOR DELINQUENT CURRENT MEMBERS IS $25.00. ALL DUES ARE CONSIDERED DELINQUENT IF NOT PAID FOR BY THE END OF THE FIRST WEEK OF THE NEW YEAR.

PLEASE MAKE YOUR DUES PAYMENTS AS USUAL OUT TO **SAPA**, BUT SEND THEM TO ME, **DORA L. ROBERTS, 6918 SUNRIVER DR., SAN ANTONIO, TX. 78244-1850**.

YOU MAY PAY YOUR DUES AS EARLY AS NOVEMBER 16th TO GET IT IN EARLY. THE EARLIER THE BETTER TO GIVE ME PLENTY OF TIME TO COMPLETE MY PAPERWORK, AND PRINT THE NEW ROSTERS ON TIME FOR THE NEW YEAR.

THANK YOU FOR YOUR CONTINUED SUPPORT FOR OUR CLUB.

SINCERELY, YOUR MEMBERSHIP CHAIR,

DORA L. ROBERTS

LEA SENGHAAS & DORA ROBERTS

PHILATEX: Editors - Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Carolyn Virta

The PHILATEX is published every two months and the cut off date is the 2nd Friday of the month prior to publication.

Mail your contributions for the Philatex to:
Philatex Editors
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San Antonio, Tx 78209
Or email either of us.
lysmitseng@gmail.com
dora.roberts@hotmail.com

Write to SAPA at:
San Antonio Philatelic Association
c/o Al Lozano
13530 FM 1560N
Helotes, TX 78023

SAPA meets at MacArthur Park Lutheran Church, 2903 Nacogdoches Rd, every Friday night at 7:30 pm in Bldg. #1, facing Nacogdoches Rd. Yearly dues are $20.00, prorated.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	Chip Swinney
Vice President:	Al Lozano
Secretary ad interim:	Fred Groth
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chair:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chair:	
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Chip Swinney
Assistant Auctioneer:	Steve Mabie

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	Chip Swinney
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
One year term:	Nancy Mabie
Two year term:	Lea Senghaas
Parliamentarian:	Harry Greer
Honorary Board Member	vacant

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee Chair:	Tony Bir

CONTACT PERSONS:

SAPA Juniors:	vacant
American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Texas Philatelic Association:	vacant
APS Circuit Books:	Steve Mabie

WE WELCOME VISITORS

Please view our website **sastamps.org** for information on our meeting schedules

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourses and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE :

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

While your purchases will be given to you during the auction, please wait until the end of the auction to pay for them. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks made out to S.A.P.A. are acceptable. Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

The glorious changing of the seasons has come, along with the rain we prayed for all summer, and cool and even some cold mornings. We had our first fire in the fireplace of the season. We started a raised bed in the front yard that will have nothing but bluebonnets. We got seeds from the wildflower seed farm near Fredericksburg and they have sprouted and are doing nicely. Many don't realize that bluebonnets actually sprout in October and go through the winter as tiny plants, even surviving freezes, and then really take off an begin blooming, often in February. Ours have done that for several years now.

On the stamp front, on that cold and wet Monday we just had, I randomly started working on my "D's".
Oh boy, Dahomy, Danish West Indies, and Danzig! After the colonial period, Dahomy only existed by that name from 1958-75, during which they issued a bunch of stamps that nobody seems to want. I like the old colonial issues of 1899-1941 the best. Danish West Indies are kind of scarce in my collection but the few I have tend to have pretty good catalog values. The US bought them in 1917 and they became the US Virgin Islands. Danzig began as a "Free City and State" under the protection of the League of Nations after WWI and ceased to exist in 1939 after the German takeover. For many issues of Danish West Indies and Danzig the used ones have a higher catalog value than the unused. Watch that.

Through stamps we travelled the world and studied history and geography. Each stamp was a lesson.

Yours in Philately, *Chip Swinney*

SA&ST POSTCARD CLUB

The San Antonio and South Texas Postcard Club meets on the third Monday of each month. Our next meeting will be held on Monday, November 20th. There will be no December meeting. The January meeting will take place on January 15th. Each month we have a predetermined postcard theme. Members bring their best postcards depicting this theme to compete for a prize. The November postcard theme is "Thanksgiving at Plymoth Rock." The postcard club is open to anyone who collects or is simply interested in postcards. The annual membership dues are $10.00. The meetings are held at the Dwyer Center of the San Antonio Genealogical & Historical Society, 903 Melissa Drive. The Dwyer Center is on the corner of Blanco Road & Melissa Drive, about one mile outside Loop 410. We start gathering at 6:30 to talk, buy, sell, and trade postcards. Our meetings start at 7:00 pm. Each meeting usually includes a short presentation by a member on some segment of his or her postcard collection. For more information about the San Antonio and South Texas Postcard Club, contact the club secretary, **Nancy Mabie**,

.NRMabie@gmail.com

UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES

November 3-4 HOUSTON TSDA Hilton Garden Inn – Energy Corridor, 12245 Katy Freeway (I-10 and Dairy Ashford Exit), Houston, TX 77079. (Fri 10-5, Sat 9-4)

November 10-11 MID-CITIES STAMP CLUB EXPO, Grapevine Convention Center, 1209 Main St., Grapevine, TX 76051. Highway 114 at Main Street exit, just north of DFW Airport. (Fri 10-5, Sat 9-4)

December 8-9 DALLAS TSDA, Doubletree Hotel, Bluebonnet Room, 1981 North Central Expressway (Hwy 75 & Campbell Rd), Richardson, TX 75080 (Fri 10-5, Sat 9-4)

Message from Auctioneer Steve Mabie

The annual SAPA Blue Chip Auction will be held on Friday, December 1, 2023. Attached is the complete list of lots being offered for sale.

The auction will start at 7:30. There are a total of 62 lots at this time. Lots will be on display at the regular SAPA meetings on November 3rd and November 17th from 6:30 - 8:00. Lots will also be available for viewing for 1 hour prior to the auction.

If you cannot attend the auction, you may submit a bid for any lot either by USPS mail or by email. Send any bids to Steve Mabie at the address below, and specify "SAPA Blue Chip Auction" in the subject line of emails. Make sure to specify the lot number and your maximum bid for that lot. You mat bid on as many lots as you wish in one email/letter. All mail-in bids must be received by Steve prior to December 1st. Please note that each lot has a minimum bid. That amount has been set by the owner and any bids less that the minimum will be discarded.

Steve Mabie
2139 Oak Creek St
San Antonio, TX 78232

This Is How Letters to Santa Were First Delivered by the U.S. Mail

Every year thousands of children write letters to Santa Claus to request the presents they want to receive from the fabled North Pole resident, and in the United States those letters are often dropped in a real mailbox. But how did that tradition start?

Some of the earliest Christmas correspondence wasn't actually written to Santa, but rather from him. In the first half of the 19th Century, Santa Claus was more of a disciplinary figure than the jolly old fellow who sorts "naughty" from "nice" these days. Stories of Saint Nicholas were meant to encourage children to behave, and some parents even wrote letters "from" Santa Claus to their children discussing their conduct over the previous year, mischievous or obedient, per *Smithsonian*.

The American image of Santa Claus developed throughout the 1800s, from the 1823 publication of the poem "A Visit From St. Nicholas"—now known by its first line, "'Twas the night before Christmas"—to cartoonist Thomas Nast's Christmas illustrations in the widely read *Harper's Weekly*. Nast's drawings of Santa, which first appeared in *Harper's* during the Civil War, helped create the visual references for Santa Claus that are still familiar today, including a red suit and white beard. Nast's drawings also captured the earliest days of the postal service's involvement in the Christmas workflow.

In 1871 Nast drew Santa Claus at his desk reading his mail and sorting it into two piles. The one labeled "letters from naughty children's parents" reaches well above his head, whereas "letters from good children's parents" is a far smaller stack. A few years later, in 1879, Nast created the first known image of someone using the U.S. mail system to write to Santa Claus. In this *Harper's* illustration, a youthful figure puts a letter addressed to "St. Claus North Pole" in a mailbox on a snowy evening.

By that point, however, the mail system was already being used for letters to Santa. On Boxing Day 1874, for example, the New York *Times* included an item about letters "deposited in the Richmond Post Office, evidently written by children, plainly indicated that they, anticipating the annual visit of Santa Claus, wished to remind him of what they most desired." The *Times* quoted a few letters: one requested "a big wagon—not so very big—four wheels, two packs pop-crackers, a Mother Hubbard book."

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At first, the U.S. Postal Service would consider letters addressed to Santa Claus undeliverable, either returning them to their senders or sending them to the Dead Letter Office. Around the turn of the 20th century, however, philanthropists and charities expressed interest in fulfilling Santa's role for poor children who sent him letters. "The Post Office Department does not believe in Santa Claus. Officially the dispenser of Christmas cheer for little folks is a myth," the *Times* wrote in 1906. "The Christmas season has no charm for the prosaic employees of the Dead Letter Office. It means only a lot of extra work and bother for them." The article went on to deplore the unsympathetic post office and "red-tape-bound officialdom" for their lack of imagination to find a way to honor the children's requests.

The following year, the Postmaster General allowed his employees to distribute the letters, but the charitable people and organizations to whom they were given found themselves faced with the task of deciding whether the children were *really* in need of their assistance. The resulting complaints meant the Postmaster General did not renew the allowance the following year.

His successor wrote an order in 1911 that all letters "addressed plainly and unmistakably to 'Santa Claus'" could be delivered to "responsible institutions or individuals" to use for "philanthropic purposes." This time permission was renewed and in 1913 made permanent. *Tonight Show* host Johnny Carson read out letters from needy children during December shows in the 1960s, helping to popularize the program. In 1989, Santa got his own ZIP Code.

The program continues today, along with a USPS scheme allowing parents to reply to their children's letters to Santa Claus.

TIME By Merrill Fabry December 21, 2015

LOT	BLUE CHIP AUCTION 2023 DESCRIPTION	CAT$	MB$
1	Switzerland, Scott #8 (A13), 10r, Yellow,Black, Red, w/o Frame Around Cross, hinged	$160.00	$75.00
2	Switzerland, Scott #10 (A12), 5r, Light Blue & Red, w/o Frame Around Cross, hinged	$160.00	$75.00
3	Switzerland, Scott #11 (A14), 15r, used, Vermillion Frame Around Cross, hinged	$775.00	$250.00
4	Switzerland, Scott #36 (A17), 5r, used, brown, hinged	$30.00	$12.00
5	Switzerland, Scott #37 (A17), 10r, used, blue, hinged	$32.50	$13.00
6	Switzerland, Scott #38 (A17), 15r, used, dark rose, hinged	$70.00	$30.00
7	Switzerland, Scott #39 (A17), 20r, used, dark orange, hinged	$77.50	$35.00
8	Switzerland, Scott #40 (A17), 40r, used, green, hinged	$92.50	$50.00
9	Hawaii, Scott #15, 1 cent, black, interisland Numeral, with HPS Certificate #2011	$650.00	$350.00
10	Hawaii, Scott #44, 10 cent, red brown, King David Kalakaua, M NG	$40.00	$10.00
11	Hawaii, Scott #47, 25 cent, dark violet, Statue of King Kamahama, M OG hinged	$160.00	$40.00
12	Hawaii, Scott #67, 10 cent, vermilion, King David Kalakaua, w/1893 OP, M OG hinged	$22.50	$6.00
13	Hawaii, Scott #60, 6 cent, green, King Kamehameha V, w/1893 overprint, M OG NH	$40.00	$20.00
14	Hawaii, Scott #79, 25 cent, deep blue, Sanford B. Dole, M OG NH	$47.50	$20.00
15	US, Scott #2624 – 2629, Voyages of Columbus, Complete Set, in orig. pkg.	$30.50	$15.00
16	US, Scott #1, Ben Franklin 5 cent imperf, thins & hole, space filler	$350.00	$35.00
17	US, Scott # 24, Franklin 1 cent Blue, clear cancelation “Oct 1860”	$40.00	$15.00
18	US, Scott #68, Washington 10 cent Green, used	$60.00	$12.00
19	US Revenue, Scott #R225, $100 Green Washington, “Series of 1914”, used	$45.00	$20.00
20	US Revenue, Scott #RE59, $100 Wine Tax, “Series of 1916”, used	$225.00	$75.00
21	US Revenue, Scott #R620 – R645, R648, set of 1953 Documentary Stamps, 27 stamps in all, some mint, some used, a few perf. Initial, on two album pages	$100.90	$35.00
22	US Possession, Guam, Scott #1, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8. 1899 issues w/GUAM Overprint, all used	$665.00	$90.00
23	US, Scott #234, 5 cent Columbian, M OG NH	$150.00	$70.00
24	US, Scott #237, 10 cent Columbian, M OG NH	$265.00	$135.00
25	US, Scott #242, $2 Columbian with faults	$200.00	$50.00
26	US, Scott #287, 4 cent Trans Mississippi, EZ Grader: 94, XF, M OG LH	$200.00	$100.00
27	US, Scott #297, 5 cent Pan-Am Expo, M OG LH	$75.00	$35.00
28	US, Scott #298, 8 cent Pan-Am Expo, M OG hinged	$90.00	$40.00
29	US, Scott #299, 10 cent Pan-Am Expo, M DOG hinged	$115.00	$55.00
30	US, Scott #325, 3 cent Louisiana Purchase, M OG NH	$170.00	$75.00
31	US, Scott #330, 5 cent Jamestown Expo, EZ Grader: 75, M OG hinged	$200.00	$100.00
32	US, Scott #549, 2 cent Pilgrim Tercentenary, XF Centering, M OG NH	$50.00	$20.00
33	European, 5 very old unstamped covers, 1841, 1833, 1851, 1856, 1845 cancellations	?	$70.00
34	US, Scott #730 & 731, full sheets of 25 stamps each, M NH, no gum as issued	$40.00	$25.00
35	US Revenue, Scott #RW1, Duck Stamp, used	$175.00	$40.00
36	US Revenue, Scott #RW7, Duck Stamp, used	$50.00	$20.00
37	(Removed)	$	$
38	(Removed)	$	$
39	People’s Republic of China, Scott #60 (A9), 1950 M no gum hinged	$45.00	$10.00

40	People's Republic of China, Scott #64 (A9), 1950 Reprint M no gum hinged	$45.00	$10.00
41	(Removed)	$	$
42	Denmark, Scott #223 a perf 13 unwmk Issue of 1933 - 40	$60.00	$15.00
43	Germany, Scott #11 (A1) Northern District Thurn & Taxis, 1859 – 60, Imperf	$80.00	$20.00
44, 45	(Removed) (Removed)	$	$
46	Germany, Scott #C38 (AP6) 1930 airmail, wmk 126	$300.00	$60.00
47	Great Britain, Scott #138 a (A74), Issue of 1902 – 11, wmk 30	$70.00	$20.00
48	Iran, Scott #90 – 100 Issue of 1894 Complete Set 0f 11 stamps, M hinged	$117.25	$40.00
49	Iran, Scott #336, Type II, 1903	$60.00	$25.00
50	Iran, Scott #337, Type II, 1903	$60.00	$25.00
51	Iran, Scott #339, Type II, 1903	$75.00	$30.00
52	Iran, Scott #589, 1917, M hinged	$45.00	$15.00
53	Iran, Scott #591, 1917, M hinged	$45.00	$15.00
54	Iran, Scott #592, 1917, M hinged	$55.00	$17.50
55	Italy, Scott #C42 – C47, Complete Set of 6 Zeppelin Airpost M hinged	$135.00	$40.00
56	Japan, Scott #125, Issue of 1913, unwmk	$40.00	$15.00
57	(Removed)	$	$
58	Switzerland, Scott #29 (A17) 40r, green	$110.00	$35.00
59	Switzerland, Scott #70 b (A19) Type I, 3r, wmk 182	$70.00	$20.00
60	Switzerland, Scott #243 – 246 Complete Set of 3	$105.00	$30.00
61	US, Scott #64 b, perf 12, Issue of 1861 - 62	$140.00	$30.00
62	US, Scott #73, perf 12, fancy cancel	$65.00	$15.00
63	US, Scott #116, perf 12, G Grill,	$110.00	$20.00
64	US, Scott #319 I, Type III, perf 12, 1908	$50.00	$10.00
65	US, Scott #621, 5 cent Norse-American Issue, 1925, Block of 4, M NH	$52.50	$20.00
66	Iran, Scott #594, 1917, M hinged	$55.00	$17.50
67	People's Republic of China, Scott #1303–06, 1345–48, 1357–1362, 14 stamps MNH Honoring Zhou Enlai, Zhu De, and Mao Zedong	$88.00	$40.00
68	US, Scott #630 (A190a), International Philatelic Exhibition Issue Souvenir Sheet, cancelled at the exhibition in New York City on October 21, 1926	?	$375.00
69	(Intentionally Left Blank)	$	$

HOW THE AUCTION WILL WORK:
PLEASE LOOK ONLY, DO NOT TOUCH LOTS.

Ask Chip for help if you need to see an item more closely.

If you have any questions, call **210-542-5448.** To write in or phone in a bid: tell us the lot #, the maximum amount you wish to bid, your name, address, phone, and email (if you have one), and phone or email your bid to: **Chip Swinney at 210-542-5448 or wswinneyjr@satx.rr.com**

You will be notified if you win a lot. If you wish to have it mailed to you, it will be sent upon receipt of payment (includes amount of bid, tax, plus postage and insurance). If you wish to make other arrangements to pick-up your purchases, contact Chip Swinney at the above email address / phone number.

ABBREVIATIONS

Av = Average (perf touches design)
AF = Almost Fine
F = Fine (perfs clear design)
VF = Very Fine (nicely centered)
S = Superb centering
MNH = Mint Never Hinged
MHR = Mint Hinge Remnant
MLH = Mint Light Hinge
NG = No Gum
OG = Original Gum
DOG = Damaged Original Gum
SE=Straight Edge
SS = Souvenir Sheet
LC = Light Cancel
MC = Medium Cancel
HC = Heavy Cancel
PNS = Plate Number Single

BIDDING & CAT

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Bidding increments go up as follows:

$5 - $10 = 50¢
$10 - $50 = $1
$50 - up = $5

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otherwise, our best estima